

This Is Why You're Failing

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 23, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/c8UdbVOHMvM> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter calls out the self-delusion of "70% consistency" in dieting — arguing it's enough to feel like you tried but not enough to succeed, and lays out a simple mindset for improving week over week.

Contents

-  The 70% Consistency Trap
-  The Fix: Progress Toward 100%

The 70% Consistency Trap 0:00

- People commonly tell Carter they're "eating right" and being "real consistent" — but when pushed for a number, many admit they're only hitting their macros and calories **~70% of days per month**
- Carter's core argument: 70% is not consistency — it's a recipe for failure disguised as effort
 - Analogy 1: "You don't feed your kids 70% of the time" — child services would remove them
 - Analogy 2: You don't feed your pets 70% of the time — that's animal abuse
 - Analogy 3: You don't brush your teeth 70% of the time
 - Point: these are non-negotiable daily habits — diet tracking should be treated the same way
- The danger of the 70% zone specifically:
 - It's "just enough to fail"
 - It's "just enough to say you tried and feel better about yourself"

"I would have rather you have done nothing, because at least if you did nothing, you wouldn't believe that you deserve success."

- Doing 70% creates a false sense of entitlement to results — you tried, so you expect progress, but the missing 30% is exactly why progress isn't coming

The Fix: Progress Toward 100% 0:44

- Carter's approach is NOT to shame or punish yourself for a bad week — it's to problem-solve immediately
 - Ask: "What do we need to do to get to 100% next week?"
 - If you don't reach 100%, maybe you reach 80% — that's still progress

- Key mindset shift: understand *exactly* why it's not working
 - "That 20% you've been doing" is the clear, identifiable cause of stalled results — no mystery, no confusion
 - Stop saying "I don't understand why it's not working" — the math is transparent
- The acceptable cycle:
 - Identify the percentage you actually hit
 - Acknowledge what the gap (the missing %) is costing you
 - Make a concrete game plan to close that gap the following week
 - Repeat — moving incrementally closer to 100%
- The standard is near-**100% consistency**, not perfection for its own sake, but because anything significantly below it statistically undermines the entire effort